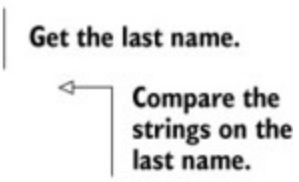
To sort the competitors by last name, you first need a function that can compare competitors on their last name. This function takes two competitor names, determines their last names, and returns `-1` if the first competitor should come first or `1` if the second competitor should come first:

```
compareOnLastName = (competitors...) ->
  lastName = (s) ->
    s.split(/\s/g)[1]
  if lastName(competitors[0]) > lastName(competitors[1])
    1
  else
    -1

compareOnLastName "0212: Turnbill, Geralyn", "0072: Renyer, Connie"
# 1
```



When you invoke `sort` with `compareOnLastName`, the array is sorted, ordering the elements:

```
competitors.sort compareOnLastName
# ["0011: Engholm, Ciara"
#  "0088: Gitting, Estrella"
#  "0072: Renyer, Connie"
#  "0455: Spielvogel, Cierra"
#  "0212: Turnbill, Geralyn"]
```

This sorting is synchronous. There's no callback—no way to say "go off and sort this array and let me know when it's done." It works, though, and a program that reads the competitors file, sorts the competitors on last name, and serves the sorted array wrapped in JSON ready to be used for the billboards is provided in the following listing.

Listing 9.1. Displaying names sorted on a field inefficiently